

Sometimes simple is better

This past month, everyone in the office has been addicted to a little game called Vampire Survivors. At a glance, this game has no business being as addictive as it is. It's got super retro graphics, a very simple (but catchy) retro soundtrack, and super simple graphics as well. It's also got extremely simple gameplay to go with it; WASD or arrow keys to move. That's about it. It wouldn't feel out of place if it was released 20+ years ago. Yet, just about everyone in the office was engrossed over the game, trying to optimise their builds and reach the 30 minute mark, which was basically where the game ended. Well, technically anyway. You could also attempt to kill the Grim Reaper that ends your life at 30 minutes and unlock him as a playable character. And we've sunk a few hours into trying to pull that off as well.

This game is what you might call a reverse bullet-hell roguelike. You've got hordes of enemies swarming you, and as you level up you've got a wide selection of weapons and power ups to select from to help you survive the onslaught. The weapons fire automatically, and there's no aiming involved for the most part. Enemy AI, like most of the game, is very simple. There's plenty of variety in the way they look, but all they do is run towards you at different speeds with different amounts of health. While you have some degree of control over what you pick, it's still mostly RNG, which actually ties in pretty nicely with our cover story this month.

Keeping gameplay fresh and exciting. Vampire Survivors has a simple concept, simple gameplay, simple graphics, yet it is highly, highly addictive. Even successfully surviving 30 minutes isn't quite enough. You will then want to optimise and theorycraft your builds next, do



–Manish “Trigger-Happy” Rajesh

SKOAR! Overlord | feedback@skoar.in

the highest amount of DPS possible, pull in the highest amount of gold, and more. We've all squeezed hours worth of gameplay from this tiny game, more than we've spent on any AAA game this month.

That goes to show you that you really don't need much to make a fun game, even if the fun is short lived. We're all pretty sure we got our money's worth and then some, plus, the game's still in Early Access, meaning we'll probably go back to check out what new challenges await us in the future. *